

STEPHEN VELA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dedicated and detail-oriented Cybersecurity Specialist with over 4 years of experience securing enterprise network architectures and leading incident response initiatives. Proven track record in vulnerability assessment, SIEM monitoring, and proactive threat hunting to protect critical IT assets against sophisticated cyber attacks and unauthorized access.

SKILLS

Technical Skills:	Network Security, Threat Hunting, Incident Response, Vulnerability Assessment, Firewall Configuration, Malware Analysis, Penetration Testing
Security Tools:	Splunk, Wireshark, Nessus, CrowdStrike Falcon, Metasploit, Snort, Palo Alto Firewalls, Kali Linux, Nmap
Languages & OS:	Python, Bash scripting, PowerShell, Linux (Red Hat, Ubuntu), Windows Server, TCP/IP networking protocols
Soft Skills:	Analytical Problem Solving, Clear Technical Communication, Cross-Functional Leadership, Crisis Management, Attention to Detail

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst <i>Aegis Network Defense</i>	June 2023 to Present Austin, TX
- Monitor enterprise infrastructure using advanced SIEM tools to detect, analyze, and mitigate real-time security alerts across 1,500 endpoint devices. - Conduct weekly vulnerability scans using Nessus, identifying critical system weaknesses and collaborating with IT operations to apply patches within 48 hours. - Lead containment and eradication procedures during suspected security incidents, reducing mean time to remediation by 25 percent over twelve months.	
Junior Security Operations Center (SOC) Analyst <i>Vanguard Tech Solutions</i>	January 2021 to May 2023 Austin, TX
- Investigated Tier 1 and Tier 2 security alerts, performing preliminary triage and escalating severe incidents to senior forensic specialists. - Configured and maintained intrusion detection systems (Snort) and firewall access control lists to prevent unauthorized ingress attempts. - Assisted in comprehensive security audits and compliance checks to ensure adherence to NIST and ISO 27001 industry frameworks.	

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity <i>University of Central Texas</i>	Graduated: December 2020 Austin, TX
Coursework Focus: Network Defense, Ethical Hacking, Cryptography, Information Security Governance, and Operating System Security.	

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

- CompTIA Security+ (ce)** (Earned March 2021) | **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)** (Earned August 2022) | **CompTIA Network+** (Earned May 2020)
- Employee of the Quarter** at Aegis Network Defense (Q4 2024) for exceptional performance during an enterprise security upgrade.

VOLUNTEER WORK

Community Cyber Hygiene Mentor <i>Austin Digital Literacy Initiative</i>	February 2022 to Present
Conduct monthly interactive workshops for local small business owners and senior citizens, teaching essential online safety practices, phishing awareness, and password security fundamentals.	